

Provincial Update

Fisheries, Aquaculture, and Wild Salmon Branch
Ministry of Water, Land, and Resource Stewardship
November 14, 2023

Ministry of Land, Water and Resource Stewardship



Ministry of
Water, Land and
Resource Stewardship

- Developing a path forward with First Nations to build a **co-managed land and resource management regime** that will ensure our natural resources are managed effectively now and in the future.
- Strengthening our commitment to **modernized land use policy and planning** and bring more certainty to investors, communities and First Nations by confirming social choice on the land base through inclusive processes. Ensure modernized land use plans are adaptive to changing climate and aligned with regional economic strategies.
- **Provincial leadership on water** policy and strategies including the coordination of government's "source to tap" strategy to protect drinking water, Coastal Marine Strategy, Watershed Security Strategy and Fund, and Wild Salmon Strategy.
- **Fisheries** and primary relationship with DFO.
- **Biodiversity and ecosystem health**, including provincial species at risk policy and program management.
- Developing a **provincial cumulative effects regime** tailored to regional circumstances.
- Modernize the **natural resources sector statutory framework and permitting processes** to ensure land-based permitting processes are transparent, timely and fair.



WLRS Ministry Mandate

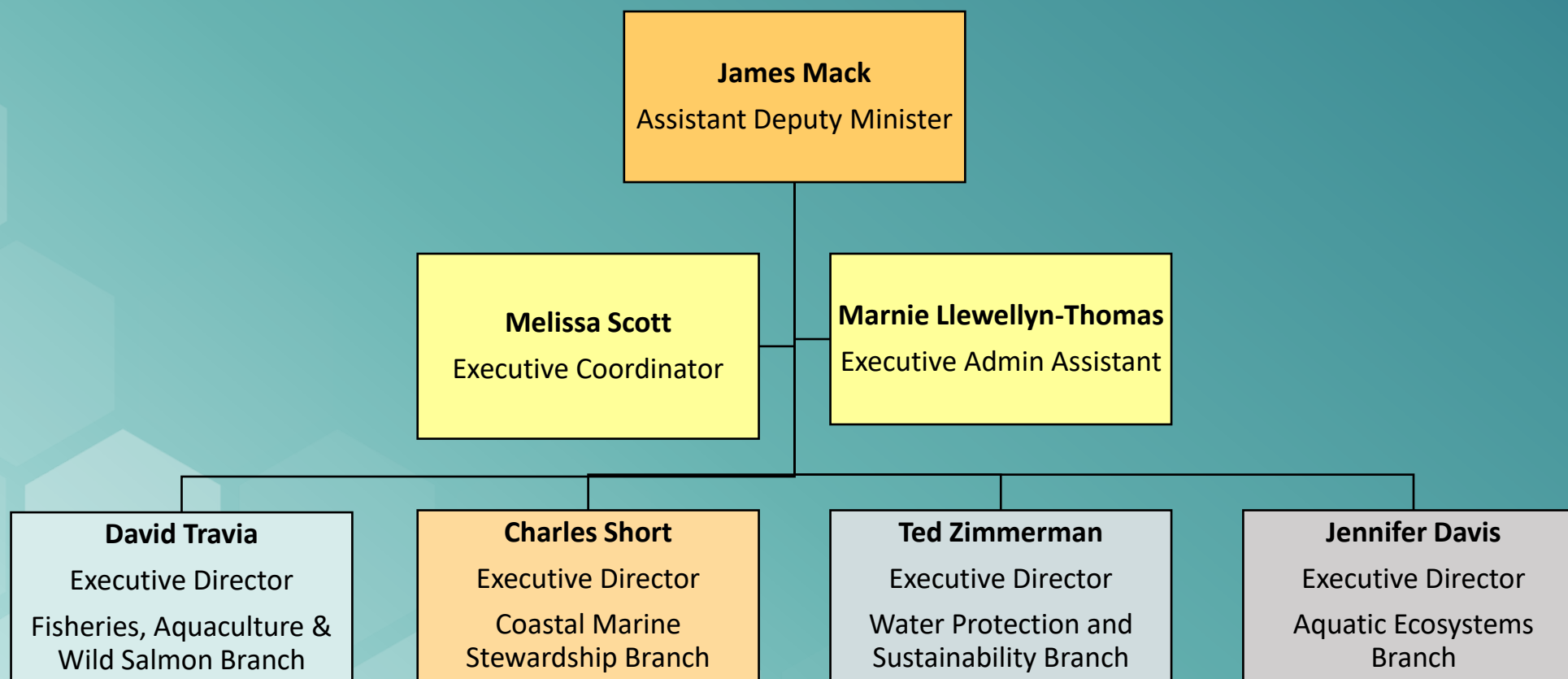
- Develop a path forward with First Nations to build a co-managed land and resource management regime that will **ensure natural resources are managed effectively** now and in the future.
- Ensure our water and watersheds are respected and valued, through the development of the **Watershed Security Strategy** and Watershed Security Fund with support from the Ministry of Environment and Climate Change Strategy.
- Lead the development of the **Coastal Marine Strategy** – in partnership with First Nations and federal governments – to better protect coastal habitat while growing coastal economies with support from the Ministry of Environment and Climate Change Strategy.
- Continue implementation of the **Wild Salmon Strategy** including working with the federal government to double the **Salmon Restoration and Innovation Fund**.



Water, Fisheries and Coastal Policy and Planning Division



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Water Protection and Sustainability Branch



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Core Functions

- Provincial water leadership
- Water policy and legislation
- Governance and planning
- Watershed and aquifer science
- Water quality standards / guidelines
- Advice, guidance and support to statutory decisions
- Transboundary and inter-governmental agreements & initiatives

Current Priorities

- Watershed Security Strategy & Fund
- Water Table
- Water hazards
- Drinking water protection
- Mackenzie River Basin Board
- Trilateral agreement (YT, NWT, AB)
- Collaborative watershed planning and governance – Eg Ft Nelson / Koksilah
- Groundwater and aquifer science
- Water quality guidelines / objectives



Ted Zimmerman
Executive Director

Interesting Facts

- 291,000 unique watersheds in BC
- WPS staff located in all major centres in BC except Ft. St. John

Aquatic Ecosystems Branch

Core Functions

- Aquatic habitat & wild fish: management, conservation, and recovery policy and plans
- First Nations collaborations & governance
- Inclusion of aquatic habitat & wild fish in integrated land and resource management
- Aquatic Conservation Science
- OPR: Riparian Area Protection Act/Reg (RAPR)
- Provincial lead - aquatic species at risk recovery
- Provincial lead - aquatic invasive fauna control
- Provincial lead - Fish Passage Program delivery

Current Priorities

- Nov 2021 flood emergency response actions for wild fish
- Science for wild salmon recovery
- Environmental flow needs
- Steelhead Recovery
- White Sturgeon Recovery
- SARA listed salmon recovery
- RAPR Assessments due to development boom & disasters
- Partner with FN Fisheries Council

Interesting Facts

- With >70 aquatic invasive, actions include >220,000 Invasive Mussel Defence inspections
- Management of wild salmon habitat is under Provincial authorities
- Applied Freshwater Research team has been co-located at UBC for more than 50 years
- The Fish Passage Program has recovered access to over 1000 km of fish/salmon habitat.
- The RAPR team adjudicates over \$1B of development investments each year



Jennifer Davis
Executive Director

Coastal Marine Stewardship Branch

Core Functions

- Strategic and Operational Support Across Government
- Coastal Marine Policy Development & Implementation
- Coastal Marine Planning and Implementation – Marine Spatial Planning (MSP)
- First Nations Collaborations & Governance
- Marine Science and Monitoring
- Represents Provincial Interests in the Coastal and Marine Space
- Stakeholder, Local Government and Public engagement

Current Priorities

- Coastal Marine Strategy (CMS) Development and co-design with First Nations
- Marine Plan Partnership (MaPP) Implementation and Financing
- Collaborative G2G (FN) or G2G2G (Canada) Governance Negotiations in South Coast and North Coast.
- Nearshore Habitat Monitoring and Baseline Establishment
- Marine Protected Area Network Implementation in Northern B.C. and selected areas on the coast.
- MSP Initiatives – South Coast

Interesting Facts

- There's over 35,000 km of coastline and over 6,500 islands in B.C
- B.C. boasts some of the largest invertebrates in the world (e.g., Giant Pacific Octopus and Sunflower Stars)
- CSMB staff are spread out on the coast from Victoria to Haida Gwaii



Charlie Short
Executive Director

Fisheries, Aquaculture & Wild Salmon Branch



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Core Functions

- Commercial and tidal recreational fisheries policy
- Finfish, shellfish and marine plant aquaculture policy
- Intergovernmental Relations and interface with DFO (e.g., CCFAM, SRKW)
- Represents provincial interests in international fisheries treaties
- Coordination and development of wild salmon recovery work
- BC Salmon Restoration and Innovation Fund administration

Current Priorities

- Enhance investment in the B.C. Salmon Restoration and Innovation Fund
- Wild Salmon Strategy
- Upcoming DFO license decisions on salmon farming and 2025 transition plan
- Advance the role of hatcheries in salmon recovery & support innovation in hatcheries
- Policy review on marine plant aquaculture licensing
- Salmon work planning with First Nations Fisheries Council

Interesting Facts

- All FAWSB staff, except for Steve Hextall (Campbell River), are based in Victoria
- Many of FAWSB have worked in private sector prior to government on commercial and recreational fisheries initiatives.



David Travia
Executive Director

Fisheries, Aquaculture & Wild Salmon Branch – Team Charter

Vision

A skilled, passionate, and high-performing team focused on results, shared success, and a positive, collaborative and trust-based culture.

Thriving and sustainable fish populations, coastal communities, and aquatic ecosystems to support environmental, social and economic outcomes for current and future British Columbians.

Mission

We provide strategic policy and intergovernmental expertise to protect and revitalize B.C.'s wild salmon populations and support sustainable commercial and recreational marine fisheries and aquaculture operations that maximize social and economic benefits for British Columbians.

Values

- Professionalism and Excellence
- Inclusivity
- Flexibility and Wellness
- Curiosity and Learning
- Respect
- Teamwork and Collaboration



David Travia
Executive Director

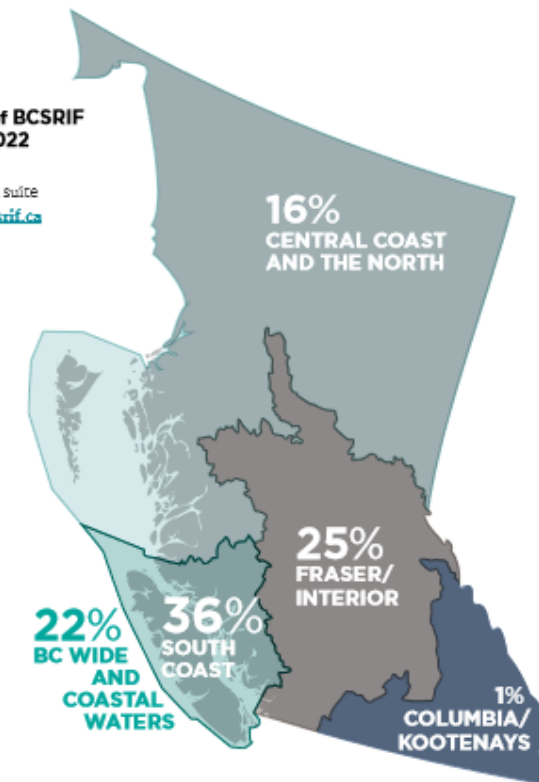
BCSRIF

- The BC Salmon Restoration and Innovation Fund (BCSRIF) Phase 1 distributed over \$128M in funding to 97 projects across the province, these projects will all be completed by March 31st, 2024.
- BCSRIF staff are working with 73 Phase 2 projects to distribute \$127.3M
- Project announcements will be released over the coming weeks.



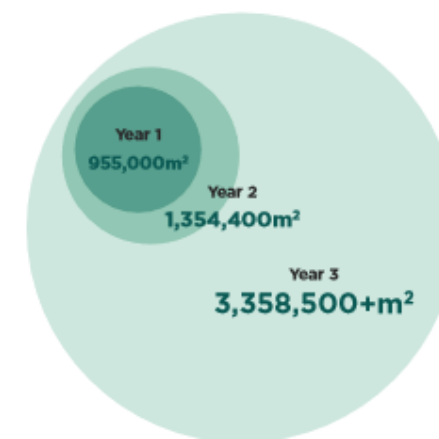
Geographic Distribution of BCSRIF Projects as of March 31, 2022

Additional information on the full suite of projects is available at www.bcsrif.ca



Total Fish Habitat Restored

Recipient's report having physically restored, or provided access to, over 3,358,500 square meters of fish habitat. In addition, over 6,087,500 square meters of aquatic invasive species control was undertaken.



Trilateral Salmon Accord

- B.C. and the First Nations Fisheries Council (FNFC) have been working together on shared priorities and have formalized their relationship.
- FNFC is a key convenor of First Nations and provincial agencies on fisheries.
- BC, DFO and FNFC are in collaborative discussions on a shared approach to wild salmon recovery in BC through a trilateral agreement.



DECLARATION ON THE RIGHTS OF INDIGENOUS PEOPLES ACT ACTION PLAN

2022-2027



2.9 Develop new strategies to protect and revitalize wild salmon populations in B.C. with First Nations and the federal government, including the development and implementation of a cohesive B.C. Wild Pacific Salmon Strategy. *(Ministry of Land, Water and Resource Stewardship)*

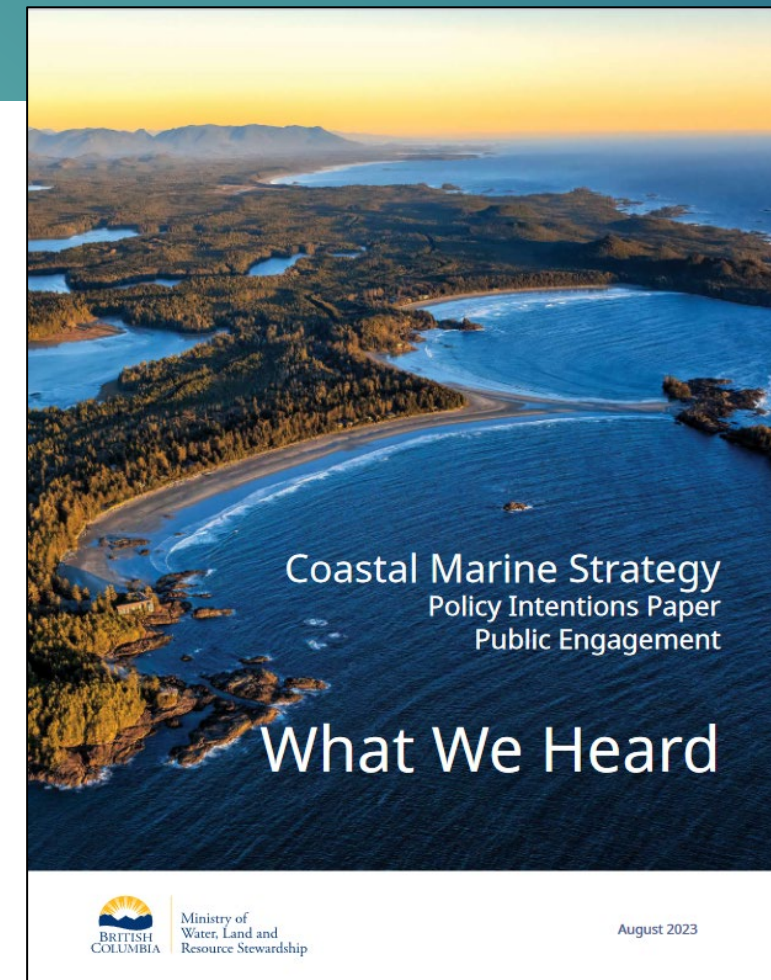
Watershed Security Strategy

- Next step in addressing wild salmon within their freshwater habitat.
- Will shape the future of watersheds and watershed management in B.C. and lead create changes for a future for B.C. where our watersheds are better cared for and stewarded together.
- Will address issues that threaten wild salmon within the freshwater environment by improving governance, data, and science, developing wholistic management approaches, and balancing the supply and demand for water at the watershed scale.
- B.C. invested \$100 million in the WSS&F that will further the legacy of contributing to watershed and salmon habitat protection and restoration.



Coastal Marine Strategy

- The Province is co-developing a Coastal Marine Strategy (CMS) with First Nations
- Will set out a shared vision for healthy coastal marine ecosystems, community well-being, and a sustainable ocean economy.
- Salmon lens being applied to CMS and being weaved into CMS intentions.
- Will include actions that protect the health of the ocean and coastal habitats, where wild Pacific salmon feed and grow.



Provincial Contacts

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